



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 24

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Adhesive & Construction Adhesive Safety

OVERVIEW:

Construction adhesives, contact cements, epoxies, and cyanoacrylate adhesives are used throughout interior finish work for panel installation, countertop setting, trim work, and casework assembly. Each product carries its own hazard profile. The key to working safely with adhesives is reading the SDS

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Skin contact with epoxy resins and hardeners is the most commonly underestimated hazard in adhesive work. Epoxy is a skin sensitizer — repeated contact causes the immune system to develop a reaction to the epoxy chemistry. Once sensitized, even trace exposures cause dermatitis, hives, or asthma-like respiratory reactions that are permanent and progressive. Nitrile gloves are the
2. Contact cement — used for countertop laminate and panel installation — is one of the most flammable products commonly used in interior finish work. Many contact cements are solvent-based and have flash points below 40 degrees Fahrenheit. This means the vapors are flammable at normal room temperature. One spark from a power tool, a light switch, or a static discharge can ignite
3. Cyanoacrylate adhesives — super glues — bond skin in seconds and can bond eyelids, lips, and fingers together permanently without surgical intervention. Never use cyanoacrylate without nitrile gloves. Keep the applicator tip pointed away from your face. Have acetone available to dissolve accidental skin bonds. If cyanoacrylate contacts an eye, do not attempt to separate bonded tissue —
4. Adhesive containers and cartridges must be capped when not in active use. Uncapped adhesive continues to off-gas solvent vapors into the work environment and can skin over the applicator tip, causing it to clog and the operator to apply extra force — which can result in sudden discharge of adhesive onto the hands or face. Cap everything between applications.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What adhesive products are we currently using on this project, and have we reviewed the SDS for each one?
Q2: What do you do if epoxy resin gets on your skin during work? Walk through the procedure.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Wear nitrile gloves — latex does not protect against most adhesives
- Epoxy sensitization is permanent: once sensitized, exposure always causes reaction
- Keep all solvent-based adhesives away from every ignition source
- Clean up spills immediately using the product-specific cleanup solvent
- Cap all tubes and containers when not in use to minimize VOC release

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 24

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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